Charcuterie Lab

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Trader Joe's Charcuterie Board Shopping List

Free printable · Our ranked picks, with amounts for 8, 12 or 20 guests (the board is the party food)

CHEESE	8 guests	12 guests	20 guests
☐ Trader Joe's Unexpected Cheddar	8 oz	12 oz	1 lb 6 oz
☐ Trader Joe's Triple Crème Brie	8 oz	12 oz	1 lb 6 oz
☐ Trader Joe's Creamy Toscano Cheese Soaked in Syrah	5 oz	8 oz	15 oz
☐ Trader Joe's 1000 Day Gouda	5 oz	8 oz	15 oz
Cheese in total	**1 lb 8 oz**	**2 lb 8 oz**	**4 lb 8 oz**

MEAT	8 guests	12 guests	20 guests
☐ Salami from the deli case	15 oz	1 lb 6 oz	2 lb 8 oz
☐ Trader Joe's Sliced Prosciutto	10 oz	15 oz	1 lb 11 oz
Meat in total	**1 lb 8 oz**	**2 lb 4 oz**	**4 lb 2 oz**

CRACKERS AND BREAD	8 guests	12 guests	20 guests
☐ Trader Joe's Cracker Assortment			
☐ A baguette from the bread shelf			
Crackers in total	**80–96**	**120–144**	**200–240**

FRUIT, NUTS, OLIVES AND EXTRAS	8 guests	12 guests	20 guests
☐ Trader Joe's Roasted & Salted Rosemary Marcona Almonds			
☐ Trader Joe's Fig Butter			
☐ Grapes, plus apples, pears or berries	1½ lb	2¼ lb	4¼ lb
☐ Olives and pickles	12 oz	1¼ lb	2¼ lb

Pack sizes vary, so buy by the ounce. Before a dinner, buy about a third less. From 20 guests the totals include 10% extra.

DON'T FORGET

- ☐ A board or large tray
- ☐ Small bowls for olives, dips and nuts
- ☐ Napkins and small plates
- ☐ Cheese knives and a spreader
- ☐ Honey or jam
- ☐ Toothpicks or cocktail forks

NOTES

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Trader Joe's: Our Top Picks

Ranked by how they work on a board, reviews, ingredients, value and how easy they are to find

THE TRADER JOE'S RANKING

1.	**Trader Joe's Unexpected Cheddar**	Everyone at the table	4.7
2.	**Trader Joe's 1000 Day Gouda**	Very aged, low price	4.7
3.	**Trader Joe's Creamy Toscano Cheese Soaked in Syrah**	A cheese that needs not…	4.7
4.	**Trader Joe's Triple Crème Brie**	The soft, spreadable che…	4.3
5.	**Trader Joe's Goat Milk Gouda**	Something different	4.2
6.	**Trader Joe's Cave Aged Blue**	The blue cheese	4.2
7.	**Trader Joe's White Stilton with Apricots**	Sweet and fruity	3.9
8.	**Trader Joe's Manchego**	A Spanish board	3.9
9.	**Trader Joe's Chèvre**	Spreading on crackers	3.9
10.	**Trader Joe's Port Salut**	Guests who like mild che…	3.6

SHOPPING TRADER JOE'S

- The cheese case rotates. If a pick is gone, swap in another cheese of the same texture.
- Trader Joe's doesn't take online orders, so plan one trip with this list.
- Trader Joe's fresh flowers are cheap. A small bunch next to the board finishes the look.

TIMELINE

The day before	Shop, wash and dry the fruit, and slice firm cheese. Store each in its own container.
1 hour before	Take out aged and firm cheese (45 to 60 minutes is best).
30 minutes before	Take out soft cheese and meat, then build the board: cheese first, then meat, then crackers, fruit and extras.
Once it's out	Serve within 2 hours, or 1 hour above 90°F. Refill from the fridge instead of putting everything out at once.

Why each pick, prices and what to skip

The full ranking is at charcuterielab.com/blog/best-trader-joes-cheeses